

Week 31: Doubt

BIG IDEA

The speaker walked away from Christianity in high school because his doubts were met with 'just believe.' Students will face doubt too, and unanswered doubts are one reason so many leave youth group after high school. Invite doubts openly and walk with students through them; God can handle any question.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- The speaker left Christianity as a high school student because he had questions and doubts and was told not to ask them, just to have faith.
- Statistics still show a large majority of students leave youth group after high school, and unanswered doubts are one reason why.
- More information often brings more questions, so keep the group an open, authentic forum that invites the difficult questions, and share your own doubts.
- Helping students navigate doubt actually furthers their faith; expressing doubts freely shows them leaders understand, have been there, and will walk with them.
- The intro activity has each student write down one question they are wrestling with; a Q&A session lets one student's question answer another's unspoken one.
- Make sure small group leaders are equipped, know it is okay to say 'I don't have an answer,' and use a storyteller who has walked through doubt.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What is one question about God or faith you have been wrestling with?
2. Have you ever felt you were not allowed to ask a question about faith? What happened?
3. Why do you think doubts, when answered honestly, can actually make faith stronger?
4. Who could you talk to when a doubt feels bigger than you can handle alone?

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